CHAPTER 7 Speed Practice

SPEED PRACTICE – 1 :

SPEED PRACTICE – 1 Time - 15 Minutes
(Lower -10 Minutes, Higher -156 Minutes)
(Lower – Junior – 1500 Strokes – 30 words, Senior – 2250 Strokes – 45 Words)

Type the following in double line spacing with a margin of 10 degrees:-

Seeing is not always Believing! While diamond is a precious gemstone, graphite is a blackish grey substance. But, then both are nothing but pure carbon. Both diamond and graphite can be synthesized from carbon and when heated, both get converted into carbon dioxide. Carbon is a non-metalic chemical element. On a weight basis, it is 19th in order of chemical abundance in the Earth's crust. Carbon is an allotrope i.e. it exists in more than one crystalline from. Its familiar crystalline forms are diamond and graphite. In its amorphous form, it is familiar as coal, charcoal and soot. It also occurs as compound in carbonaceous rocks such as chalk and limestone, as carbon dioxide in the atmosphere, as hydrocarbons in petroleum, coal and natural gas and as a constituent of all organic substances.

Diamond which is nothing but pure carbon is regarded as precious gemstone. It is the hardest substance known. It is at the top of the scale of hardness or Moh's scale. It is 10 on this scale and talc, the softest known mineral is 1. The mineral will scratch any other mineral lower on the scale than itself and similarly any other mineral higher on the scale will scratch it. Diamonds were known before 3000 B.C. and until their discovery in Brazil in 1725, India was the main source of diamonds. Present sources of diamonds are South Africa, Australia, Ziare, Botswana, Russia, Namibia and Angola.

In South Africa, diamonds were first discovered in 1866. The largest diamond every found was Cullian diamond. It weighed 3106 carats and was found in the Premier Mine, South Africa in 1095. It was cut into 9 major and 96 small stones. The two largest diamonds, star of Africa and Cullian II are set in the British royal regalia. The two other big rough diamonds are Excelsior (995.2 carats), which was found in South Africa in 1905 and Star of Sierra Leone (968.9 carats), found in Yengema in 1972. The primary source of diamonds is kimberlitea soft, bluish- coloured periodic rock. It was named after famous deposit at Kimberly, South Africa. Kimberlites occur in volcanic structures called kimberlite pipes. Diamonds may also be found in alluvial deposits resulting from weathering of primary sources.

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